ARCHITECTS INTERIOR DESIGNERS STUDENTS

Mastering
AI-Rendering

A STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE

Starting AI-Rendering journey? Find out where to begin and how to achieve it perfectly.

AI 3D RENDERLAB

A Note From the Creator

As an architect with a Master's degree in Parametric Architecture and the co-founder of a professional Architectural visualization studio, I understand that high-quality AI rendering is built through workflow, creative direction, and real-world visualization experience — not random prompts.
This is not another generic prompt book with 100-200 random copied prompts and no practical application.
Weeks of research, testing, resource collection, and workflow refinement have gone into creating these studio-grade AI rendering workflows for exterior visualization, interior rendering, and presentation design.

Every technique and workflow in this guide has been personally curated and used in professional projects to help architects, designers, and visualization artists create reliable, high-quality results with AI.
The goal of this guide is simple:
to help you build a professional, repeatable, and production-ready AI visualization workflow.

AI 3D RENDERLAB

Guide **Overview**

WHO THIS IS FOR ?

This guide is for architects, interior designers, and students who want to use AI to elevate their visual output—not just experiment with it.

YOU'LL BENEFIT IF YOU:

- Use SketchUp, 3DSmax, Lumion, Enscape, V-Ray or similar tools
- Struggle with flat, unrealistic, or inconsistent renders
- Try prompts but don't get reliable results
- Want visuals that impress clients, studios, or juries

Better visuals = better perception = better opportunities

THE REAL PROBLEM ?

Not lack of tools
Lack of a system

WHAT THIS GUIDE SOLVES :

- Convert basic models into photoreal, client-ready visuals
- Use AI with clarity and control
- Apply a repeatable prompt system
- Improve lighting, materials, and atmosphere
- Create high-impact presentations—faster

Shift from: guessing prompts
To: controlling results

AI RENDERING WORKFLOW

FROM MODEL TO MAGICAL REALISTIC OUTPUT

01 WHAT YOU NEED BEFORE STARTING

A BASE IMAGE
(SketchUp / 3ds Max / any 3D model screenshot)

AN AI TOOL
(Nano banana pro / chat gpt / midjourney)

A CLEAR IDEA OF OUTPUT
(realistic / tropical / luxury / night / etc.)

IMPORTANT: AI does NOT create good architecture from scratch. It enhances what you give.

02 STEP-BY-STEP WORKFLOW (CORE PROCESS)

01 PREPARE MODEL

- Take a clean screenshot
- Use simple lighting
- Keep geometry clear

Better input → Better output

02 UPLOAD BASE IMAGE

- Open your AI platform
- Upload your image
- Use it as base/reference image

03 BUILD PROMPT

Use this structure:

[Subject] + [Style] + [Materials] + [Lighting] + [Mood] + [Camera]

Example (Simple Version):
Modern villa, tropical style, concrete and wood materials, soft daylight, lush greenery, cinematic wide angle

04 GENERATE & ADJUST

- Click Generate / Enter
- Wait for the results
- Check output and adjust:
  - Lighting
  - Materials
  - Mood

Do NOT expect perfect result in 1 try.

05 FINALIZE OUTPUT

- Upscale image
- Slight post-processing (optional)
- Add finishing details (people, cars, plants)

SIMPLE RULE

Good Input
+ Smart Prompt
+ Iteration
= Professional Output

MODEL → SCREENSHOT → UPLOAD → PROMPT → GENERATE → REFINE

CONTROL THE PROCESS. **CREATE MAGIC.**

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001 Basic to advanced exterior AI-rendering.

Fundamental modifications applied to a building's form, structure, materials, or spatial organization to redefine its design, performance, or visual identity.


EXTERIOR
AI-RENDERING

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Sketchup → Realisitc image

Preserving all materials, Turn any basic Software image to **photorealisitc image with vegetation.**

Before

After

Prompt 01

Ultra-realistic exterior photograph taken with a full-frame DSLR camera at midday, rigorously preserving all colors, materials, and geometries of the provided [**SketchUp**] model, no colors or materials may be altered, urban setting: surrounding vegetation, complementary vegetation consistent with a Brazilian residential neighborhood, with shadows cast on the lawn and asphalt, the street asphalt should be realistic, with strong and well-defined shadows - especially the shadows of the palm tree, trees, and the upper volume of the house - reinforcing the harsh midday light, realistic asphalt texture: micro-cracks, stains, dust, and a slight dry sheen, lighting: strong midday sun, harsh light, short and precise shadows, intense blue sky without fog, natural reflections on the white of the architecture, camera: 35mm lens, f/8, ISO 100, 1/400 s — sharp focus, realistic depth of field, natural contrast, slight chromatic aberration at the edges, soft grain, and slightly warm white balance (5400K), the image should look like a real photograph taken in a Brazilian urban neighborhood, preserving 100% of the colors of the original architectural volumes, without altering materials or modifying the palette, add subtle vignetting, details in 8K.

***NOTE :** If any another software is used, replace it with “SketchUp.” Also feel free to alter the prompt to fit your needs.

Sketchup → Realisitc image

Universal prompt - Turn any basic **sketchup image to photorealisitc image.**

Before

After

Prompt 02

Transform this [**SketchUp**] screenshot into a photorealistic architectural render. Preserve exact geometry, proportions, camera angle, and composition. Apply realistic materials (concrete, wood, glass, metal, stone) with accurate textures, imperfections, and reflections. Add natural lighting based on real-world conditions (soft sunlight, global illumination, ambient occlusion, realistic shadows). Enhance with context: detailed landscaping, sky, environment, depth, and atmospheric perspective. Include subtle realism elements like dirt, edge wear, reflections, and material variation. Add scale elements (people, furniture, vehicles if appropriate) in a natural, non-distracting way. Style: ultra-realistic, high dynamic range, cinematic lighting, physically accurate rendering, 8k, sharp focus. Avoid: cartoon look, over-saturation, distortion, incorrect proportions, extra structures, unrealistic materials.

***NOTE :** If any another software is used, replace it with "SketchUp."

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

3DS max → Realisitc image

Universal prompt - Turn any basic **3DSmax/Vray image to photorealisitc image**

Before

After

Prompt 03

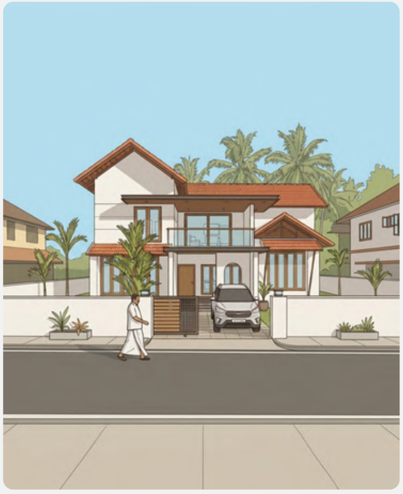
Transform this [**3DSmax/Vray**] screenshot into a photorealistic architectural render. Preserve exact geometry, proportions, camera angle, and composition. Apply realistic materials (concrete, wood, glass, metal, stone) with accurate textures, imperfections, and reflections. Add natural lighting based on real-world conditions (soft sunlight, global illumination, ambient occlusion, realistic shadows). Enhance with context: detailed landscaping, sky, environment, depth, and atmospheric perspective. Include subtle realism elements like dirt, edge wear, reflections, and material variation. Add scale elements (people, furniture, vehicles if appropriate) in a natural, non-distracting way. Style: ultra-realistic, high dynamic range, cinematic lighting, physically accurate rendering, 8k, sharp focus. Avoid: cartoon look, over-saturation, distortion, incorrect proportions, extra structures, unrealistic materials.

***NOTE :** If any another software is used, replace it with “3DSmax/Vray”. This works for a model created without materials, using only plain color surfaces.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Sketchup → Realisitc image

Contextualize the model in a **Kerala-inspired tropical landscape** with abundant greenery.



Before

After

Prompt 04

Convert this [**SketchUp**] model screenshot into a hyper-realistic Kerala residential scene, keeping the original building's proportions but upgrading all textures, materials, and lighting for real-world detail. Place the home in a lush Kerala setting with dense tropical vegetation, coconut trees, banana plants, hibiscus, crotons, and natural red soil. Add Kerala-style people casually walking along the road—man in mundu with motion blur—integrated with realistic shadows and perspective. Include a typical Kerala neighborhood feel with a few other houses in the background. Add a car commonly seen in Kerala in the 15–20 lakh price range, such as a Hyundai Creta, Kia Seltos, or Honda Elevate,in the car porch. Use a morning sunlight with deep, soft shadows, cinematic wide-angle framing, and ultra-detailed photorealistic rendering with compound wall gates.. The final output should look like a real photograph taken in Kerala with rich atmosphere, slight natural imperfections, and high-end architectural visualization quality.

***NOTE :** This remains effective even if no vegetation is present in the base model. If any another software is used, replace it with "Sketchup".

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Sketchup→ Realisitc image

Contextualize the model in a modern **luxury Bangalore residential scene.**

Before

After

Prompt 05

Re-render this image into a hyper-realistic modern luxury Bangalore residential scene, keeping the original building's proportions intact while upgrading all textures, materials, and lighting for real-world detail. Place the home in an upscale Bangalore Dollars Colony / Sadashivanagar / RMV-style elite neighborhood with lush manicured landscaping, ornamental trees, trimmed hedges, palm clusters, flowering shrubs, and premium paved streets. Add a refined urban greenery palette with rain trees, areca palms, bougainvillea, and curated garden beds. Include affluent Bangalore neighborhood context with elegant neighboring villas/bungalows partially visible on the sides. Add realistic Indian residents casually interacting—well-dressed upscale urban family / jogger / domestic help—integrated naturally with accurate shadows and perspective. Include a premium car commonly seen in Bangalore luxury neighborhoods parked in the driveway/front yard such as a Mercedes GLC, BMW X1, Audi Q3, Toyota Fortuner, or Kia Carnival. Use soft golden morning Bangalore sunlight with deep yet natural shadows, cinematic wide-angle framing, and ultra-detailed photorealistic rendering. Add premium compound wall gates, subtle street infrastructure, realistic paving, slight weathering, and natural imperfections so the final output resembles a real architectural photograph shot in an affluent Bangalore neighborhood with rich atmosphere and high-end visualization quality.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Sketchup→ Realisitc image

Contextualize the model in an **American residential neighborhood**

Before

After

Prompt 06

Ultra-realistic exterior photograph taken with a full-frame DSLR camera at midday, rigorously preserving all colors, materials, and geometries of the provided SketchUp model with no alterations under any condition, set within an upscale American residential neighborhood characterized by a clean, low-density suburban environment with regionally appropriate vegetation such as oak and maple trees, ornamental grasses, trimmed hedges, and curated front lawns, avoiding any tropical landscape cues; include a realistic American asphalt road with subtle wear like fine micro-cracks, patch variations, faint oil stains, dust, and a dry matte sheen, along with concrete sidewalks, curbs, driveway aprons, and clean lawn transitions; lighting should feature strong midday sun with harsh, direct illumination producing short, crisp, well-defined shadows from trees and architectural elements, maintaining high contrast and a deep clear blue sky without haze; ensure physically accurate reflections on glass and light-colored surfaces without overexposure; use camera settings of 35mm lens, f/8, ISO 100, 1/400 sec for sharp focus, realistic depth of field, natural contrast, slight chromatic aberration, subtle grain, and a mildly warm white balance (~5400K); incorporate authentic suburban elements such as mailboxes, garage doors, driveways, and street signs without distracting from the architecture; apply subtle vignetting and controlled HDR for an ultra-detailed 8K result that reads as a real photograph while strictly preserving 100% of the original design, materials, and color integrity.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Day time→ Night time

Converting a **daytime image into a night-time** render.

Before

After

Prompt 07

Convert the provided realistic exterior architectural image into a cinematic night-time render, rigorously preserving all geometry, proportions, materials, and architectural details without distortion or redesign; maintain material identity and surface characteristics while allowing natural night-time color response under artificial lighting with no unrealistic shifts. Replace all daylight with a physically accurate night setup featuring deep blue ambient sky illumination, soft low-intensity moonlight, and primary reliance on artificial sources such as warm interior lighting, facade lighting, street lights, landscape lighting, and controlled spill light. Ensure shadows are soft, diffused, and layered with realistic falloff and contrast, eliminating harsh midday shadows. Adapt the environment to night with a darker sky, subtle atmospheric depth, slight haze for light bloom, and realistic reflections on glass and mildly reflective surfaces like asphalt, stone, and water. Enhance realism through controlled light glow, bloom, and subtle glare, visible interior lighting through windows, and a balanced warm–cool contrast between warm artificial lights and cool night ambience. Use a full-frame DSLR aesthetic with a 35mm lens, f/2.8–f/4, ISO 400–800, slower shutter feel, cinematic depth of field, controlled noise or grain, and natural contrast. Apply post-processing with subtle vignetting, cinematic color grading using teal-blue shadows and warm highlights, high dynamic range, and ultra-detailed 8K output, ensuring the final image reads as a professionally captured architectural night photograph rather than an over-stylized render.

Night time → Day time

Converting a **night time image into a day time** render.

Before

After

Prompt 08

Convert the provided realistic exterior architectural image into a natural daylight render, rigorously preserving all geometry, proportions, materials, and architectural details without distortion or redesign; maintain material identity and surface characteristics while allowing accurate daylight color response with no unrealistic shifts. Replace all artificial night lighting with a physically accurate daylight setup featuring a bright sky dome, dominant natural sunlight as the primary light source, and subtle ambient sky illumination; eliminate visible artificial lighting effects such as glow, bloom, and excessive interior light spill, keeping any interior lighting minimal and overpowered by daylight. Ensure shadows are crisp yet natural, directionally consistent with the sun position, with realistic contrast and defined edges typical of daytime conditions. Adapt the environment to day with a clear or lightly clouded sky, enhanced atmospheric clarity, natural visibility, and accurate reflections on glass and reflective surfaces like asphalt, stone, and water under daylight. Emphasize realism through balanced global illumination, proper exposure, and true-to-life color reproduction, avoiding cinematic night-style grading. Use a full-frame DSLR aesthetic with a 24–35mm lens, f/8–f/11, ISO 100–200, fast shutter feel, high sharpness, deep depth of field, and clean noise-free output. Apply post-processing with neutral color grading, accurate white balance, moderate contrast, high dynamic range, and ultra-detailed 8K output, ensuring the final image reads as a professionally captured architectural daytime photograph rather than a stylized render.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Sketchup→ Realisitc image

Contextualize modern corporate **office tower model in a premium Bangalore IT park.**

Before

After

Prompt 09

Re-render this image as a hyper-realistic modern corporate office tower in a premium [**Bangalore**] IT park, preserving original geometry, proportions, and camera view while upgrading all materials, textures, and lighting to photoreal standards. Set within a [**Whitefield/Manyata/Global Village/Marathahalli/HBR**]-style tech corridor with wide roads and organized campus planning. Use sleek glass-and-steel architecture with curtain wall glazing, aluminum fins, louvers, double-height lobby, stone, concrete, and metal details. Add corporate landscaping, adjacent offices, professionals, premium vehicles, organized parking, bright late-morning light, crisp shadows, atmospheric depth, and micro-details like wear, smudges, drainage, and reflections for a clean, aspirational photographic finish high clarity subtle haze.

***NOTE :** Replace the **city/place name** with a location of your choice.

Image→ Change camera angle

Change the camera angle from the original fixed view to a new one.

Before

After

Prompt 10

Re-render the given building image into a high-quality, photorealistic scene, preserving the original building's geometry, proportions, and design intent while upgrading all materials, textures, and lighting to real-world standards. Position the camera to capture the building from [**above the building looking downward**], ensuring accurate perspective, depth, and visibility of architectural elements based on this viewpoint. Adjust façade exposure, roof visibility, and spatial relationships accordingly, maintaining correct scale, lens behavior, and vanishing points. Enhance the surrounding context appropriately (urban / residential / commercial), adding realistic landscaping, ground detailing, roads, and environmental elements that naturally respond to the chosen viewpoint. Include people and vehicles where relevant, properly scaled and integrated with realistic shadows, reflections, and perspective alignment. Use cinematic natural lighting [**morning / evening / neutral daylight**], with soft, physically accurate shadows and global illumination that reinforce realism and depth. The final output should resemble a real photograph, with balanced composition, natural imperfections, atmospheric depth, and high-end architectural visualization quality.

***NOTE :**

Replace Only This Part → (**camera position**)

- above the building looking downward
- from the left side at eye level
- from the right side at eye level
- directly in front at street level
- from behind the building
- from an elevated aerial position
- from a distant wide perspective
- close to the façade with a wide lens
- from a corner showing two faces of the building

Why this works

- Avoids rigid keywords like "**top view / side view / left view**" that sometimes distort results
- Gives more control over composition + realism
- Keeps your workflow modular and fast

Only If the design / style is inconsistent add this at the end of the prompt "Maintain identical design, only change camera position"

Image→ Advanced Control

Universal parametric **prompt to get advanced control** over the image and **create custom mood.**

Before

After

Prompt 11

Transform the provided image into a [**Mood**] while strictly preserving original geometry, composition, camera angle, and materials; use [**Lighting**] with [**Colour temperature**] and [**Intensity**], ensuring realistic shadows and global illumination; set the scene to [**Time of the day**] with [**Sky**]; add [**Atmosphere**] with subtle depth and realism; apply [**Colour grade**] with balanced contrast and natural dynamic range; introduce [**Accents**] to enhance mood without altering the design; render in an ultra-realistic, cinematic style with ray-traced lighting, high detail, and natural imperfections; maintain constraints of no geometry change, no redesign, and no material replacement—only lighting, atmosphere, and color transformation.

***NOTE :** To create a realsitc-render from the customised moodboard, check out our "**Ultimate AI-Rendering workflow**" on gumroad **(AI 3D Renderlab)**

*NOTE : Swap the keywords with the below keyword control system for best results :

🎭 **MOOD (overall intent — optional but useful)**
- cinematic night
- rainy evening
- golden hour warmth
- soft overcast
- cyberpunk neon
- cold winter
- luxury dusk

💡 **LIGHTING (primary light behavior)**
- soft diffused
- directional hard light
- low-key dramatic
- volumetric light
- HDR natural
- neon emissive

🌡️ **COLOR_TEMPERATURE (light color only — avoid overlap with grading)**
- warm amber
- neutral daylight
- cool blue
- mixed warm interior + cool exterior

🔆 **INTENSITY (exposure / contrast control)**
- low light
- balanced exposure
- high contrast

🕒 **TIME_OF_DAY (only temporal context)**
- sunrise
- midday
- sunset
- blue hour
- night

☁️ **SKY (background condition only)**
- clear
- overcast
- dramatic clouds
- stormy

🌫️ **ATMOSPHERE (only volumetric/environmental particles)**
- clean air
- light haze
- fog
- rain
- mist

🎨 **COLOR_GRADE (final cinematic look — separated from lighting)**
- teal-orange cinematic
- desaturated neutral
- warm filmic
- cool cinematic
- high contrast editorial

✨ **ACCENTS (small enhancements — optional)**
- wet ground reflections
- interior warm glow
- street lights
- neon highlights
- soft light beams

Image→ Style Transformation

Universal parametric prompt to **transform the Architectural style** of the structure/building.

Before

After

Prompt 12

Transform the provided architectural image/model into [**Neo-Futurism**], strictly preserving the original geometry, proportions, spatial hierarchy, materials logic, and camera composition—no structural redesign, no massing changes, and no added or removed elements; apply the style holistically by adapting material expression, façade articulation, openings, detailing, and structural language in a manner authentic to Art Deco while remaining fully buildable and physically plausible; maintain real-world material behavior with accurate joins and tectonic consistency; use natural, physically accurate lighting and global illumination with realistic shadows and reflections appropriate to the scene; ensure the context, atmosphere, and colour response subtly align with the architectural style without overpowering the design; output an ultra-realistic architectural visualization with high detail, sharp textures, no distortion, no surrealism, and no redesign.

***NOTE :** Replace **Neo-Futurism** with an Architectural style of your choice. Example - Brutalism, Art deco, Minimalism.

Image → Add rain

Universal parametric prompt to **add rain** into the scene.

Before

After

Prompt 13

Change the scene to a rainy day. Overcast sky, soft diffused light, wet surfaces, realistic rain outside the windows, subtle reflections on the ground, moody atmosphere, natural lighting, photorealistic render

***NOTE :** Keeping prompts minimal at times leads to better results, as it allows the AI to make more optimal decisions on its own.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Image→ Add people

Universal parametric prompt to **add Realisitc people** into the scene.

Before

After

Prompt 14

Add highly realistic human figures into the scene, defined as [**User type**], ensuring they are fully context-aware and appropriate to the environment; maintain accurate human scale using correct perspective, camera position, and spatial depth, and position figures naturally within logical circulation and activity zones without obstructing key architectural elements; assign realistic, candid behaviors such as [**Actions**] with natural body language and unscripted interactions; automatically adapt clothing, styling, and cultural expression to match the environment, climate, and social context with diversity in age, gender, and posture; match all existing lighting conditions with correct direction, intensity, color temperature, and shadow behavior, generating physically accurate contact shadows, reflections, and ambient occlusion to ground figures convincingly; ensure photorealistic detailing including natural skin tones, micro-textures, and fabric response, while maintaining proper depth layering with accurate occlusion, perspective scaling, and lens effects such as depth-of-field or motion blur where applicable; avoid repetition by introducing variation across all figures, ensuring the final composition integrates seamlessly to enhance realism, scale, and narrative without distracting from the architecture.

***NOTE :** To add ultra realisitc people, check out our workflow on gumroad **(AI 3D Renderlab)**

***NOTE : Swap the keywords with the below keyword control system for best results :**

Quick High-Quality Combos

- Indian families + walking, casual conversation
- security guards + standing, monitoring entrance
- office workers + walking, checking phone
- children + playing, running
- luxury residents + strolling, relaxed interaction
- café customers + seated, talking, drinking coffee

Image→ Add cars

Universal parametric prompt to **add Realisitc cars** into the scene.

Before

After

Prompt 15

Add highly realistic vehicles into the scene, defined as [**Vehicle model**], ensuring they are fully context-aware and appropriate to the environment; maintain accurate vehicle scale using correct perspective, camera position, and spatial depth, and position vehicles naturally within logical circulation zones such as roads, driveways, parking areas, and drop-off points without obstructing key architectural elements; assign realistic, candid states such as [**Action**], ensuring natural orientation, lane alignment, and believable spacing; automatically adapt vehicle selection, condition, and styling to match the environment, socio-economic context, and location (e.g., urban Indian streets, premium developments, commercial zones), including variation in brands, colors, and types; match all existing lighting conditions—ensuring correct reflections, highlights, shadow direction, intensity, and color temperature, with physically accurate contact shadows, reflections, and ambient occlusion to ground vehicles convincingly; ensure photorealistic detailing including material finishes (paint, glass, rubber), subtle imperfections (dust, wear), and accurate reflectivity; maintain proper depth layering with correct occlusion, perspective scaling, and lens effects such as motion blur for moving vehicles or depth-of-field where applicable; avoid repetition by introducing variation across all vehicles, ensuring the final composition integrates seamlessly to enhance realism, scale, and narrative without distracting from the architecture.

***NOTE : Swap the keywords with the below keyword control system for best results :**

Quick High-Quality Combos

- Kia seltos + parked.
- Indian mid-range cars + entering/exiting.
- luxury sedans, premium SUVs + parked, arriving.
- high-end electric vehicles + parked, charging.
- neighborhood vehicles + parked, occasional movement.

Image→ Add Animals / birds

Universal parametric prompt to **add Realisitc Animals/birds** into the scene.

Before

After

Prompt 16

Add highly realistic animals and/or birds into the scene, defined as [**Animal type**], ensuring they are fully context-aware and appropriate to the environment; maintain accurate anatomical scale using correct perspective, camera position, and spatial depth, and position them naturally within logical zones such as ground planes, vegetation, edges, ledges, or open sky without obstructing key architectural elements; assign realistic, candid behaviors such as [**Action**], ensuring natural posture, movement, and species-specific behavior; automatically adapt species selection, grouping, and appearance to match the environment, climate, and regional context (e.g., Indian urban or residential settings), including variation in size, color, and posture; match all existing lighting conditions—ensuring correct direction, intensity, color temperature, and shadow softness, with physically accurate contact shadows, reflections, and ambient occlusion to ground them convincingly; ensure photorealistic detailing including fur, feathers, skin textures, and subtle imperfections with correct material response; maintain proper depth layering with accurate occlusion, perspective scaling, and lens effects such as motion blur for flying birds or depth-of-field where applicable; avoid repetition by introducing variation across all animals/birds, ensuring the final composition integrates seamlessly to enhance realism, scale, and environmental narrative without distracting from the architecture.

***NOTE : Swap the keywords with the below keyword control system for best results :**

Ready-to-Use Killer Combos

- pigeons + pecking, scattered perching (works in almost any scene)
- street dogs + resting, slow wandering (adds grounded realism instantly)
- crows + perched, occasional flying (Indian urban authenticity)
- sparrows + perched, hopping, light flight (clean + subtle for premium renders)
- cows + standing, slow grazing (strong cultural grounding—use carefully)
- butterflies + hovering, gentle movement (adds life in landscape scenes)

High-Confidence Realism Combos :

1. Urban Indian Baseline (safest default)

- street dogs + resting, wandering slowly
- pigeons + pecking,(short flight), perched
- crows + perched, scavenging

2. Residential / Calm Context (subtle realism)

- pet dogs + sitting, walking with owner
- sparrows + perched, hopping
- cats + resting, strolling

3. Premium / Landscape / Luxury (clean + controlled)

- small birds (finches, sparrows) + flying lightly, perched on edges
- butterflies + hovering, moving gently
- ornamental birds + perched, subtle movement

4. Active Street Layer (adds life without chaos)

- pigeons + flocking, scattering
- street dogs + walking, interacting casually
- crows + flying, landing

5. Cultural / Indian Context (very grounded)

- cows + standing, grazing slowly
- goats + wandering, grazing
- temple pigeons + clustered

6. Water / Landscape Edge (if applicable)

- ducks + floating, swimming
- birds + flying low, landing near water

Image→ Add Blurred entities

Universal parametric prompt to **add blurred entities** into the scene.

Before

After

Prompt 17

Add highly realistic blurred entities into the scene, defined as [**Subject type**], ensuring they are fully context-aware and appropriate to the environment; maintain accurate scale using correct perspective, camera position, and spatial depth, and position them naturally within logical circulation and activity zones such as walkways, roads, edges, or open space without obstructing key architectural elements; assign realistic, candid behaviors such as [**Actions**], ensuring natural motion direction and believable trajectories; apply physically accurate motion blur based on speed, direction, and camera settings (shutter speed, focal length), with consistent blur intensity and directionality—moving elements exhibit directional blur while partially static elements retain sharper definition; automatically adapt appearance, type, and contextual relevance (e.g., urban vehicles, pedestrians, birds) to match the environment, including variation in form, size, and grouping; match all existing lighting conditions—ensuring blurred highlights, reflections, and shadow trails align with scene lighting, with soft but accurate contact shadows and ambient occlusion where applicable; ensure photorealistic material response even within motion blur (e.g., light streaks on cars, softened silhouettes of people, feather blur in birds), while maintaining proper depth layering, occlusion, and perspective scaling;

avoid overuse or excessive blur—balance sharp and blurred elements to preserve focal hierarchy and architectural clarity; introduce variation in motion intensity and distribution, ensuring the final composition integrates seamlessly to enhance dynamism, realism, and narrative without distracting from the architecture.

***NOTE : Swap the keywords with the below keyword control system for best results :**

- [SUBJECT_TYPE] (e.g., people, cars, animals, birds)
- [ACTIONS] (e.g., walking, moving, flying, passing, turning, scattering)

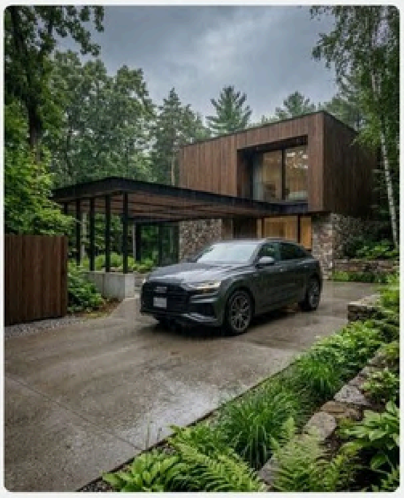
EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Image→ Style transfer

Transfer mood, lighting from the reference image; preserve original composition and geometry.

Before (Image-1)

***Reference image** (Image-2) : Use this image to transfer mood lighting.*



After

Prompt 18

Match the [**rainy**] mood from second image to the first image.

***NOTE :** Use Image-1 as the base and Image-2 as the mood reference; replace "rainy" with the reference mood in the Image-2 (e.g., sunny, rainy, cloudy, foggy).

Image→ Edit with json prompt

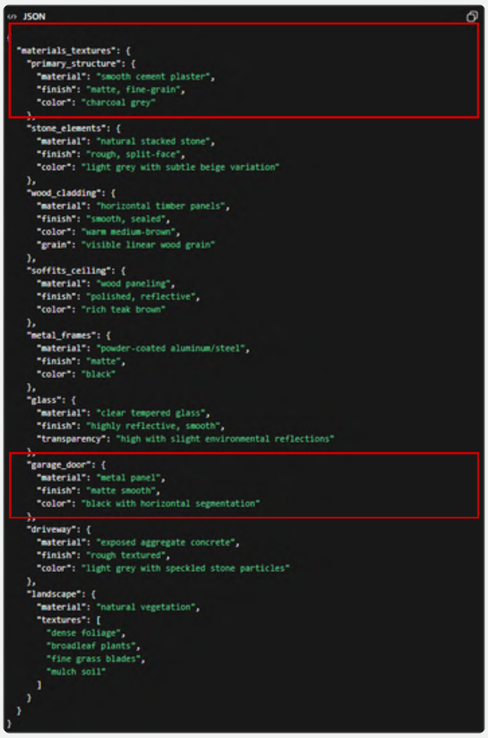
Working with JSON prompt, precisely focusing on **changing materials / textures / colour.**

Step - 1: Upload the base image and enter the below prompt in chatgpt.

Prompt 19 : Analyse this image and write a JSON prompt focusing on material and texture.

Step - 2: Editing the json prompt recived from chat gpt / gemini.

JSON Prompt



```json
{
  "materials_textures": {
    "primary_structure": {
      "material": "smooth cement plaster",
      "finish": "matte, fine-grain",
      "color": "charcoal grey"
    },
    "stone_elements": {
      "material": "natural stacked stone",
      "finish": "rough, split-face",
      "color": "light grey with subtle beige variation"
    },
    "wood_cladding": {
      "material": "horizontal timber panels",
      "finish": "smooth, sealed",
      "color": "warm medium-brown",
      "grain": "visible linear wood grain"
    },
    "soffits_ceiling": {
      "material": "wood paneling",
      "finish": "polished, reflective",
      "color": "rich teak brown"
    },
    "metal_frames": {
      "material": "powder-coated aluminum/steel",
      "finish": "matte",
      "color": "black"
    },
    "glass": {
      "material": "clear tempered glass",
      "finish": "highly reflective, smooth",
      "transparency": "high with slight environmental reflections"
    },
    "garage_door": {
      "material": "metal panel",
      "finish": "matte smooth",
      "color": "black with horizontal segmentation"
    },
    "driveway": {
      "material": "exposed aggregate concrete",
      "finish": "rough textured",
      "color": "light grey with speckled stone particles"
    },
    "landscape": {
      "material": "natural vegetation",
      "textures": [
        "dense foliage",
        "broadleaf plants",
        "fine grass blades",
        "mulch soil"
      ]
    }
  }
}
```

Editing JSON Prompt

Edit the prompt only where the change is required. Example- if only primary structure colour and garage door has to changed then, edit only the below part and replace the keywords :

{
"materials_textures": {
"primary_structure": {
"material": "smooth cement plaster",
"finish": "matte, fine-grain",
"color": "**off white**"

},
"garage_door": {
"material": "metal panel", "finish": "matte smooth",
"color": "**red with horizontal segmentation**"

Step - 3 : Reupload the image in nano banana and enter the below prompt with edited json

Prompt :
Create a view of the exterior scene based on this JSON prompt :

```
{
 "materials_textures": {
  "primary_structure": {
   "material": "smooth cement plaster",
   "finish": "matte, fine-grain",
   "color": "off white"
  },
  "stone_elements": {
   "material": "marble stone",
   "finish": "rough, split-face",
   "color": "light grey with subtle black variation"
  },
  "wood_cladding": {
   "material": "horizontal timber panels",
   "finish": "smooth, sealed",
   "color": "warm medium-brown",
   "grain": "visible linear wood grain"
  },
  "soffits_ceiling": {
   "material": "wood paneling",
   "finish": "polished, reflective",
   "color": "rich teak brown"
  },
"metal_frames": {
 "material": "powder-coated aluminum/steel",
 "finish": "matte",
 "color": "black"
},
 "glass": {
 "material": "clear tempered glass",
 "finish": "highly reflective, smooth",
 "transparency": "high with slight environmental reflections"
 },
 "garage_door": {
 "material": "metal panel",
 "finish": "matte smooth",
 "color": "red with horizontal segmentation"
 },
 "driveway": {
 "material": "exposed aggregate concrete",
 "finish": "rough textured",
 "color": "light grey with speckled stone particles"
 },
 "landscape": {
 "material": "natural vegetation",
 "textures": [
 "dense foliage",
 "broadleaf plants",
 "fine grass blades",
 "mulch soil"
 ]
 }
 }
}
```

Step - 4 : Final output

***NOTE :** Use the same JSON extraction approach to modify trees, weather, and overall mood.

- JSON is a programming language, **use this approach to have precise controll over any particular changes.**

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

Image→ Unfinished structure

Universal Prompt to Deconstruct the finished building into a **raw, under-construction state.**

Before

After

Prompt 20

Transform the provided exterior image into an active construction site / unfinished state, strictly preserving the original geometry, proportions, camera angle, and composition—no redesign or massing changes; replace finished surfaces with raw construction conditions such as exposed concrete, brickwork, rebar, scaffolding, formwork, incomplete façades, open edges, temporary supports, and partially installed elements; introduce authentic site irregularities including uneven surfaces, debris, stains, dust, chipped edges, misalignments, and visible material transitions; populate the scene with context-aware construction activity like cranes, excavators, mixers, trucks, temporary fencing, site cabins, stacked materials (steel, bricks, cement bags), cables/wires, safety nets, tarpaulins, and barricades, along with workers in helmets and vests performing realistic tasks with accurate scale and placement; adjust the environment and atmosphere to reflect a live site with dusty air, light haze, muted tones, natural lighting with soft shadows, and subtle motion cues (e.g., lifted materials, equipment positioning), while maintaining photorealism through correct global illumination, material roughness, and depth—ensuring the final output reads as a mid-construction snapshot that is functional, imperfect, and believable without altering the core design intent.

***NOTE :** Upload always a high realisitc image.

Image→ Object closeup shot

Universal Prompt to Create a **beautiful closeup shot.**

Before

After

Prompt 21

Create a beautiful closeup shot showing [**one of the**] detail of this image, use depth of field to blur, add bokeh, show details on focus, add some detailed, small objects

***NOTE :** Replace “**one of the**” with the intresting object of your choice. example - “**table**”

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

CASE STUDY 001

Basic 3D model → Contextualizing the model in a **modern luxury Bangalore residential scene**.

(img.1) Base image created from Sketchup.

Step - 1 : Prepare 3D model and base image

***Software used** : Sketchup is used to prepare 3D model and set a decent camera angle and export the 2d image (png preffered)*

Prepare your 3D model and generate the base render using SketchUp or any 3D software, ensuring that you set the final output dimensions in advance. For instance, if your target output is 4:5 (928 × 1152 px), the base image must be rendered in the exact same aspect ratio and resolution. This prevents any distortion, cropping, or stretching during AI rendering and preserves composition integrity.

Step - 2 : Upload the base image to any AI and apply the prompt

***AI used** : Go to Google Gemini, select "Nano-Banana pro", upload the image (img.1) and enter the below prompt.*

Prompt 01 - is being used to just render the image quickly and check how the render comes out.

Ultra-realistic exterior photograph taken with a full-frame DSLR camera at midday, rigorously preserving all colors, materials, and geometries of the provided [**SketchUp**] model, no colors or materials may be altered, urban setting: surrounding vegetation, complementary vegetation consistent with a Brazilian residential neighborhood, with shadows cast on the lawn and asphalt, the street asphalt should be realistic, with strong and well-defined shadows - especially the shadows of the palm tree, trees, and the upper volume of the house - reinforcing the harsh midday light, realistic asphalt texture: micro-cracks, stains, dust, and a slight dry sheen, lighting: strong midday sun, harsh light, short and precise shadows, intense blue sky without fog, natural reflections on the white of the architecture, camera: 35mm lens, f/8, ISO 100, 1/400 s — sharp focus, realistic depth of field, natural contrast, slight chromatic aberration at the edges, soft grain, and slightly warm white balance (5400K), the image should look like a real photograph taken in a Brazilian urban neighborhood, preserving 100% of the colors of the original architectural volumes, without altering materials or modifying the palette, add subtle vignetting, details in 8K.

***NOTE :** Replace "**Sketchup**" with any other software that you have used to create the model.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

CASE STUDY 001

Basic 3D model → Contextualizing the model in a **modern luxury Bangalore residential scene**.

(img.3) Rendered image created from step-2

(img.4) Rendered image created from step-3

Step - 3 : Re-view the render

Reasoning : *The quick render (img.3) turned out well, Now wanted to adapt and situate the model within a Bangalore-context. Now upload the image (img.3) and enter the prompt.*

Prompt 05 - used to visualize the rendered model in bangalore-specific context.

Re-render this image into a hyper-realistic modern luxury Bangalore residential scene, keeping the original building's proportions intact while upgrading all textures, materials, and lighting for real-world detail. Place the home in an upscale Bangalore Dollars Colony / Sadashivanagar / RMV-style elite neighborhood with lush manicured landscaping, ornamental trees, trimmed hedges, palm clusters, flowering shrubs, and premium paved streets. Add a refined urban greenery palette with rain trees, areca palms, bougainvillea, and curated garden beds. Include affluent Bangalore neighborhood context with elegant neighboring villas/bungalows partially visible on the sides. Add realistic Indian residents casually interacting—well-dressed upscale urban family / jogger / domestic help—integrated naturally with accurate shadows and perspective. Include a premium car commonly seen in Bangalore luxury neighborhoods parked in the driveway/front yard such as a Mercedes GLC, BMW X1, Audi Q3, Toyota Fortuner, or Kia Carnival. Use soft golden morning Bangalore sunlight with deep yet natural shadows, cinematic wide-angle framing, and ultra-detailed photorealistic rendering. Add premium compound wall gates, subtle street infrastructure, realistic paving, slight weathering, and natural imperfections so the final output resembles a real architectural photograph shot in an affluent Bangalore neighborhood with rich atmosphere and high-end visualization quality.

Step - 4 : Remove white car

Reasoning : *Since the white car in (img.4) doesn't align with the overall color palette, it needs to be removed.*

Custom Prompt : Remove the parked white car.

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

CASE STUDY 001

Basic 3D model → Contextualizing the model in a **modern luxury Bangalore residential scene**.

Step - 5: Add car

Reasoning : *Add a punchy and solid colour car to elevate the luxury.*

Prompt 05 - To add specific car model to the scene.

Add highly realistic vehicles into the scene, defined as [**Black range rover sport**], ensuring they are fully context-aware and appropriate to the environment; maintain accurate vehicle scale using correct perspective, camera position, and spatial depth, and position vehicles naturally within logical circulation zones such as roads, driveways, parking areas, and drop-off points without obstructing key architectural elements; assign realistic, candid states such as [**exiting**], ensuring natural orientation, lane alignment, and believable spacing; automatically adapt vehicle selection, condition, and styling to match the environment, socio-economic context, and location (e.g., urban Indian streets, premium developments, commercial zones), including variation in brands, colors, and types; match all existing lighting conditions—ensuring correct reflections, highlights, shadow direction, intensity, and color temperature, with physically accurate contact shadows, reflections, and ambient occlusion to ground vehicles convincingly; ensure photorealistic detailing including material finishes (paint, glass, rubber), subtle imperfections (dust, wear), and accurate reflectivity; maintain proper depth layering with correct occlusion, perspective scaling, and lens effects such as motion blur for moving vehicles or depth-of-field where applicable; avoid repetition by introducing variation across all vehicles, ensuring the final composition integrates seamlessly to enhance realism, scale, and narrative without distracting from the architecture.

(img.5) Option -1 , Rendered image created by step-5

(img.6) Option -2 , Rendered image created by step-5

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

CASE STUDY 001

Basic 3D model → Contextualizing the model in a **modern luxury Bangalore residential scene**.

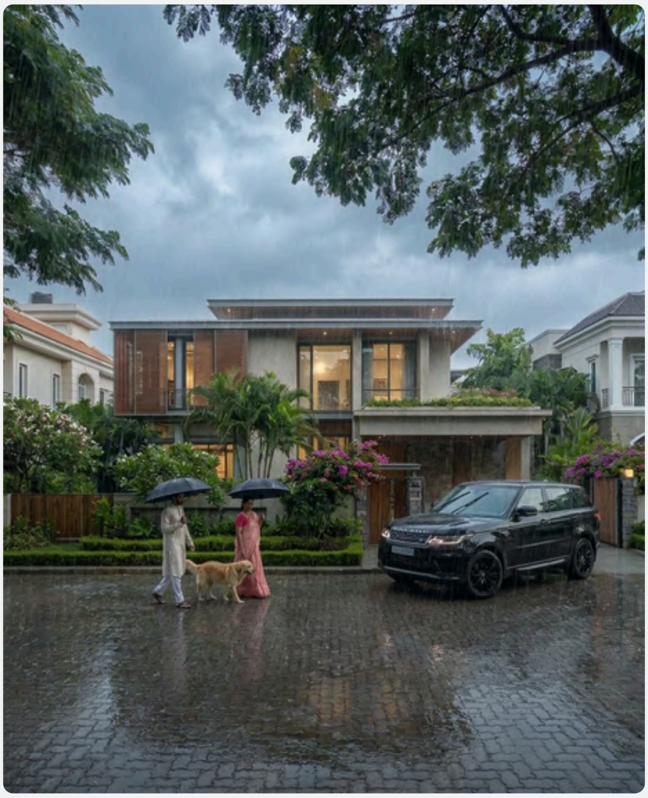
(img.7) Rendered image created from step-6

Step - 6 : Add Rain

Reasoning : *Selecting Option 2 (Img.6) as it aligns better with the overall composition, while introducing a rain effect to add subtle drama to the scene.*

Prompt 13 - To add rain effect.

Change the scene to a rainy day. Overcast sky, soft diffused light, wet surfaces, realistic rain outside the windows, subtle reflections on the ground, moody atmosphere, natural lighting, photorealistic render



(img.8) Rendered image created by step-7

Step - 7 : reflect the rainy conditions.

Reasoning : *As its raining, person jogging in the rain must be removed and have the individuals hold umbrella.*

Custom Prompt - Remove the jogging person and make the two people in the middle hold black umbrella due to rain

EXTERIOR AI-RENDERING

CASE STUDY 001

Basic 3D model → Contextualizing the model in a **modern luxury Bangalore residential scene.**

(img.9) Rendered image created from step-8

Step - 8 : Closeup shot

Reasoning : *To add extra detail, and get the realisitc closeup shot, enter the below prompt.*

Prompt 21 - To create closeup shot.

Create a beautiful closeup shot showing [car] detail of this image, use depth of field to blur, add bokeh, show details on focus, add some detailed, small objects

Step - 9 : Upscale the image

Reasoning : *To increase the pixel density, image clarity when we zoom, it must be upscaled. Upload the images (img.8) & (img.9) and type below prompt.*

Custom Prompt - Upscale it to 2k/4k.

(img.10) Final Upscaled images created by step-9

(img.11) Final Upscaled images created by step-9

THE END

A Note From the Creator

As an architect with a Master's degree in Parametric Architecture and the co-founder of a professional architectural visualization studio, I understand that high-quality AI rendering is built through workflow, creative direction, and real-world visualization experience — not random prompts.
This is not another generic prompt book with 100-200 random copied prompts and no practical application.
Weeks of research, testing, resource collection, and workflow refinement have gone into creating these studio-grade AI rendering workflows for exterior visualization, interior rendering, and presentation design.

Every technique and workflow in this guide has been personally curated and used in professional projects to help architects, designers, and visualization artists create reliable, high-quality results with AI.
The goal of this guide is simple:
to help you build a professional, repeatable, and production-ready AI visualization workflow.

AI 3D RENDERLAB

SAMPLE

002 Basic to advanced interior AI-rendering.

Sample of Our Studio-Grade AI Interior Rendering Workflow

TAKE A LOOK

↓

Interior visualizations transforming spatial layouts, materials, lighting, and furnishings to enhance realism, atmosphere, functionality, and aesthetic presentation for clients


INTERIOR
AI - RENDERING

Sketchup→ Realisitc image

Universal prompt - Turn any basic **sketchup image to photorealisitc image.**

Before

After

Prompt 01

THE END

SAMPLE

CHAPTER N.3

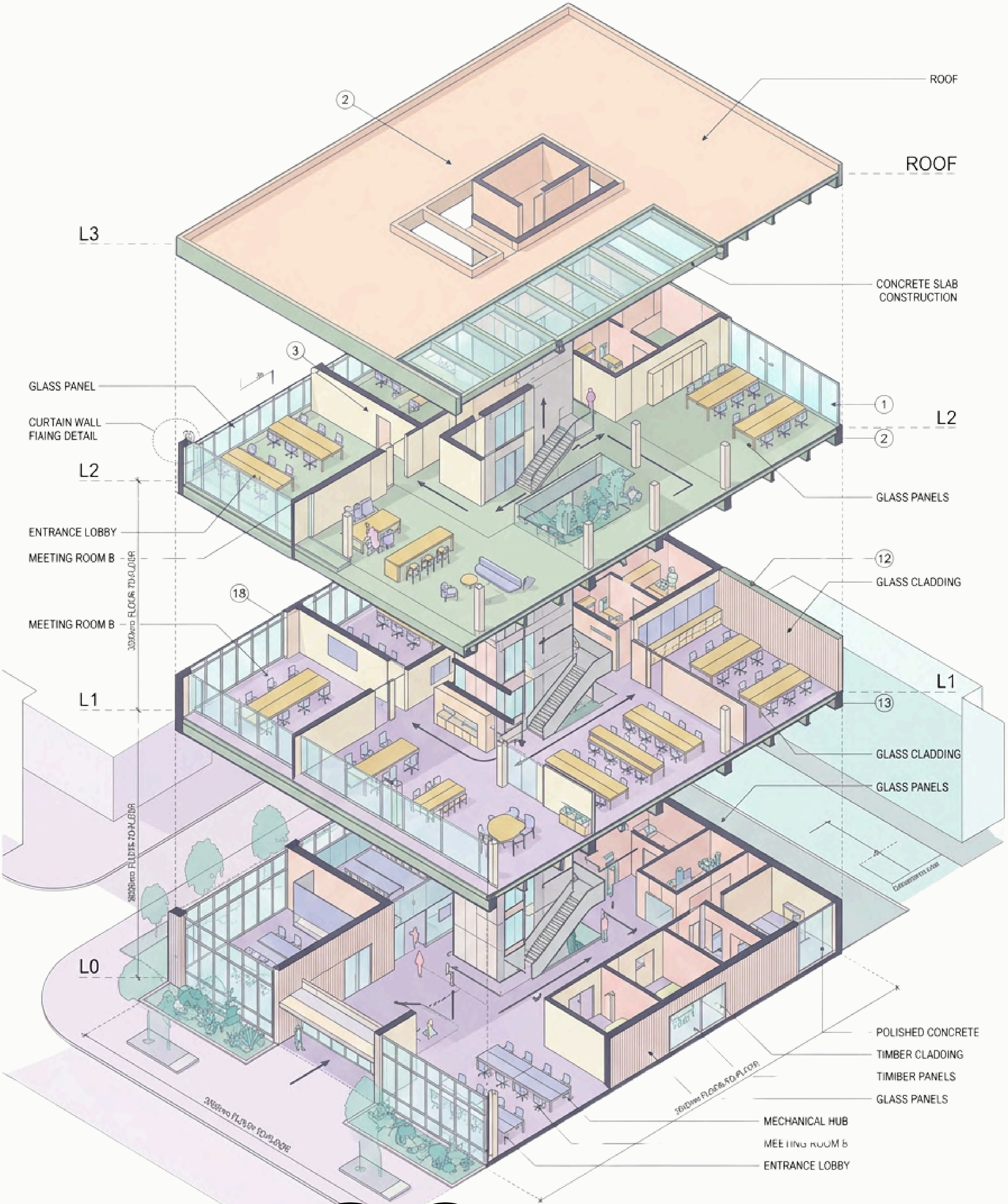
003 Basic to advanced design AI-rendering.

Sample of Our Studio-Grade AI design Rendering Workflow

TAKE A LOOK

↓

presentation frameworks organizing architectural concepts, visuals, layouts, typography, and narratives to improve communication, clarity, engagement, and professional project delivery



AI - DESIGN PRESENTATION

AI - DESIGN PRESENTATION

Image→ Material moodboard

Universal prompt - **Create a detailed accurate material moodboard from a image.**

Before

After

Prompt 01

Create a high-end interior design material moodboard using only the materials present in the 3D scene. Arrange the samples in an artistic, layered composition similar to luxury architectural boards, with realistic textures, shadows, and soft studio lighting. Include stone, wood, fabric, metal, and color swatches exactly as they appear in the scene, presented as physical material tiles and samples. Use a refined neutral background, elegant styling, and balanced layout to achieve a premium, photorealistic moodboard aesthetic.

*NOTE : Use this moodboard to create stunning interior scenes as a reference.

THE END

BONUS : Curated Visual Prompt Recipes for AI Image Generation

BONUS

Curated Visual Prompt Recipes for AI Image Generation

VISUAL PROMPT RECIPES

Modern kitchen →

Prompt 01

A wide shot captures the exterior of a modern building with a facade of red brick. The building features a series of large, arched openings on its upper levels, with intricate wooden latticework visible within. A curved, golden-colored walkway or canopy extends from the left side of the frame, leading towards the entrance of the building. Below the arches, there are storefronts with glass doors and windows, some displaying merchandise. Lush green plants cascade from balconies and are placed in planters around the entrance, adding a touch of nature to the architectural design. In the foreground, a wet, paved area with a curved water feature and gentle fountains suggests a recent rain or a well-maintained public space. The sky above is a clear, pale blue, indicating it might be late afternoon or early morning.

***NOTE :** Use this prompt and alter the parameters to get unique original high quality images.

Ferrari parked on street →

Prompt 02

A matte dark green Ferrari SF90 Stradale is parked on the side of a street in front of a grand, white building with a curved facade. The building has large windows with dark curtains and ornate balconies. The sky is overcast with soft clouds. The car is the main subject, positioned in the foreground and taking up a significant portion of the frame. The lighting is subdued, creating a moody and sophisticated atmosphere.

***NOTE :** Use this prompt and alter the parameters to get unique original high quality images.

Ornate courtyard→

Prompt 03

An ornate courtyard with a central octagonal fountain is the main focus of this image. The courtyard is surrounded by a two-story structure featuring intricate arches, columns, and detailed carvings. Large, plush red cushions are scattered around the fountain, suggesting a comfortable seating area. Lush green potted plants are strategically placed throughout the courtyard, adding a touch of nature to the architectural beauty. The overall impression is one of serene elegance and traditional design.

***NOTE :** Use this prompt and alter the parameters to get unique original high quality images.

Luxurious outdoor bar→

Prompt 04

A wide shot captures a luxurious outdoor bar and pool area at dusk. The main subject is a modern, open-air bar with a curved, wooden roof illuminated by warm LED lights. The bar itself is made of wood and features a long counter with stools, backed by shelves stocked with bottles and glasses. To the left of the bar, there's a comfortable seating area with a plush sofa and potted plants. In front of the bar, a freeform swimming pool with a mosaic tile bottom curves gracefully through the scene. The pool is lit from within by soft, white LED strips that follow its contours, creating a magical glow. Palm trees and lush greenery surround the area, adding to the tropical ambiance. In the background, more lounge chairs and umbrellas are visible, hinting at a resort or hotel setting. The sky above is a clear, soft blue, transitioning into twilight. The overall mood is serene, elegant, and inviting.

***NOTE :** Use this prompt and alter the parameters to get unique original high quality images.

Arched stone hallway→

Prompt 05

A white horse stands in the center of a long, arched stone hallway. The hallway is lined with potted plants and has a wooden ceiling. To the right, a white sofa with pillows sits next to a wooden barrel. In the background, an open doorway reveals a sunlit courtyard. The lighting is warm and natural, casting long shadows.

***NOTE :** Use this prompt and alter the parameters to get unique original high quality images.

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THANK YOU

★★★★★

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